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# The Fed & Macro Regime Pillar Report

## Liquidity as the Master Driver — Researched, Scored, and Re-Rated

*Originally written and scores committed by me on June 12, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (re-rated up to a moderated 40/38/47/55/62 on the BLS July jobs report, committed and stamped by Alex). Re-rated up again August 13 to 43/41/48/56/62 on a cool CPI print and a weak claims print; held flat August 14 as the pending H.4.1 trigger fired and confirmed; held flat again August 16 as July retail sales reinforced, but didn't advance, the same direction — committed and auto-stamped, the last true baseline. A same-day-earlier August 22 catch-up draft independently re-verified the Aug 16-22 window (jobless claims, FOMC minutes, retail sales, rate-odds) and held flat — that draft was fully delivered (rendered, verified, archived) before this cycle began.* ***This version (August 22, score set `2026-08-22_draft2`) is the FULL WEEKLY refresh — the first deep multi-source research dive since August 8 — and again HOLDS FLAT at 43/41/48/56/62.*** *Fresh this cycle: the Aug 19 FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc runs wider than the three named dissenters ("several participants" beyond them favored a hike; "many participants" saw tightening as possibly necessary); the 30-year Treasury yield hit a ~19-year high of 5.31-5.33%, driven substantially by fiscal-deficit concern (CBO raised its FY deficit projection to $2.1T) and heavy long-bond supply rather than pure Fed repricing; equities sold off Aug 20 (S&P -0.87%, Dow -1.32%, partly a Walmart-earnings shock) before partially recovering Aug 21; and CME FedWatch/Kalshi/Polymarket/investing.com/defirate.com were independently re-pulled and cross-checked, converging on ~68-70% September-hold odds essentially unchanged before and after the minutes landed — the hawkish content was already priced. A separately-circulating "93.6% September hike probability" figure was traced this cycle to a garbled conflation with Kalshi's July-meeting hold odds and is confirmed not credible, explicitly discarded rather than used. July retail sales' genuine miss (-0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% consensus) is a real but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal that, per this pillar's own discipline against chasing single prints, doesn't move P by itself.* ***Net: real hawkish detail offset by an already-priced market and a noisy dovish print — a wash. P holds flat.*** *PCE (July data, due Aug 26) and Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair (Aug 28, "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy") are logged pending as the two highest-signal events on the near-term calendar.* ***LEFT AS A DRAFT, AWAITING MY STAMP — NOT AUTO-STAMPED, because this is a FULL WEEKLY***

***refresh categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp authority*** *regardless of how routine the underlying evidence is; see My Decision below.*

## The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

*June column committed by me on June 12, 2026. Aug 16 remains the last committed baseline — it has NOT been superseded today. The Aug 22 draft1 column is the same-day-earlier catch-up cycle, already fully delivered before this cycle began. Aug 22 draft2 is this cycle — the full weekly refresh — held flat, LEFT AS A DRAFT (not auto-stamped; full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the daily delegation, regardless of how routine the evidence is).*



| WINDOW | JUN | ... | 8/16 | 8/22 D1 | 8/22 D2 | QUAL. | IMP. | SIGNAL | MY CALL |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1 month** | 38 | ... | 43 | 43 | **43** | 0.85 | 8 | **−0.95** | Mild Bear — a wider hawkish bloc in the FOMC minutes is offset by already-priced rate odds and a genuine but noisy weak retail-sales print; nets to a wash |
| **3 months** | 40 | ... | 41 | 41 | **41** | 0.85 | 8 | **−1.22** | Mild Bear — Sept FOMC still in this window; a 19-year-high 30yr yield and a still-live hawkish dissent offset by flat rate-odds and soft retail sales |
| **6 months** | 46 | ... | 48 | 48 | **48** | 0.80 | 8 | **−0.26** | Mild Bear, close to Neutral |
| **1 year** | 54 | ... | 56 | 56 | **56** | 0.75 | 8 | **+0.72** | Neutral/Mild Bull |
| **3 years** | 61 | ... | 62 | 62 | **62** | 0.65 | 8 | **+1.25** | Mild Bull — structural accumulate |

**Last committed P (Aug 16):** 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 · **Aug 22 draft1 (delivered, catch-up cycle):** 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 · **This cycle's draft P (Aug 22 draft2, full weekly refresh, held flat, NOT yet committed):** 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P − 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 38/40/46/54/61 (Jun 12) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8-Aug 15 path) → Aug 16 43/41/48/56/62 (held flat — July retail sales missed hard, reinforcing but not sized into a fresh move) — committed, auto-stamped → **2026-08-22_draft** 43/41/48/56/62 (held flat — same-day catch-up cycle, independently re-verified the Aug 16-22 window; delivered) → **2026-08-22_draft2** 43/41/48/56/62 (held flat — this cycle, the full weekly refresh: FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc wider than known, a 19-year-high 30yr yield, an equity selloff/partial-recovery, and a cross-venue rate-odds re-check all found to net to a wash against a genuine but noisy weak-retail-sales print) — LEFT AS A DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED because full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from Alex's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, independent of how clean the evidence is.

### THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

**P** — the odds the macro regime is *good for crypto* by then — not "the Fed cuts by then." Held flat this cycle at 43/41/48/56/62. This is a full weekly refresh: a deeper multi-source research pass than the lighter daily/catch-up touches run since Aug 8, including today's own earlier draft1. The Jul 28-29 FOMC minutes (federalreserve.gov, primary, published Aug 19) show the hawkish bloc was wider than the three named dissenters — "several participants" beyond Hammack/Kashkari/Logan favored a hike, and "many participants assessed that policy tightening would likely be necessary if inflation did not decline." But this cycle's independent, direct cross-check of CME FedWatch, Kalshi, Polymarket, investing.com, and defirate.com found September-hold odds clustered ~68-70% across all five, essentially unchanged before and after the minutes landed on Aug 19 — the hawkish detail was already priced by the market. Meanwhile July retail sales (Census.gov, primary) missed hard (-0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% consensus, steepest drop since May 2025, though still +5.0% y/y and partly calendar-noise from Prime Day shifting into June) — a genuine but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal that, per this pillar's standing discipline against chasing single prints, doesn't move P alone. The 30-year Treasury yield's ~19-year high (5.31-5.33%, around Aug 17-18) compounds with the hawkish minutes optically but is substantially a fiscal-deficit and long-bond-supply story (CBO raised its FY deficit projection to $2.1T, ~$200B above its February estimate), not purely a Fed repricing — labeled accordingly, not treated as a clean hawkish signal. Net: real hawkish detail, real dovish-leaning noise, an already-priced market — a wash. Nothing here clears this pillar's re-rate threshold.

**Quality** — how trustworthy the evidence is. Unchanged this cycle per house rules.

**Impact** — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. Liquidity is the tide; it moves the whole market at once.

**Carried forward from Aug 14:** Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 12 (federalreserve.gov primary) showed reserve balances fell $49,290M w/w to $2,944,059M against a $56,626M TGA rebuild to $963,950M — directionally the same reserve-drain/TGA-rebuild pattern already priced in, confirmation not a fresh trigger.

## The Claim

*The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated August 22, 2026, full weekly refresh*

**The crowd:** might read the Aug 19 FOMC minutes' wider hawkish bloc, the 19-year-high 30yr yield, and the Aug 20 equity selloff together as a clean hawkish escalation. That reads the headlines, not the pricing — the market's own rate-odds venues barely moved around the minutes at all.

**Me:** holding at 43/41/48/56/62. A full weekly research pass found the hawkish minutes detail real but already priced (CME FedWatch/Kalshi/Polymarket/investing.com/defirate.com all read ~68-70% September hold, essentially flat before and after Aug 19), the 30yr yield's spike substantially a fiscal-deficit/supply story rather than a pure Fed repricing, and July retail sales' genuine miss too noisy on its own to move P. Nets to a wash.

**My edge:** the discipline is in cross-checking the market's own pricing directly rather than inferring it from headline reactions, and in naming and discarding bad data rather than quietly ignoring it — this cycle traced a circulating "93.6% September hike probability" claim to a garbled conflation with Kalshi's July-meeting hold odds and threw it out. Bank of America's own read of the underlying data set (still 75bp of hikes) remains the honest counter-case this report keeps printing rather than burying, and the Aug 28 Jackson Hole speech — Warsh's first as Chair — is the real catalyst still ahead, not anything found this cycle.

## The Facts

*As of August 22, 2026, full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is the first deep multi-source research dive since Aug 8; the lighter daily/catch-up facts below (including today's earlier draft1) are carried forward and re-confirmed, not re-derived. The Iran/Hormuz war-risk situation is covered in full in the Iran War Risk pillar report.*

- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — the Jul 28-29 FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc runs wider than previously known (federalreserve.gov, primary, published Aug 19; corroborated by CNBC, Quartz, Newsquawk, goldsilver.com).** Beyond the three named dissenters (Hammack, Kashkari, Logan, who voted for an immediate hike), "several participants" also favored a hike at the meeting, and "many participants assessed that policy tightening would likely be necessary if inflation did not decline." Inflation cited: PCE 4.1% (May actual), core 3.4%; the June staff estimate was 3.7% headline / 3.3% core, "remains elevated." Labor cited: unemployment steady at 4.2% (June), wage growth 3.5% y/y (moderating).
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — the 30-year Treasury yield hit 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high (highest since 2007), around Aug 17-18** (Bloomberg, CNBC, Axios). Driven substantially by fiscal/deficit concerns — the CBO raised its FY deficit projection to $2.1T, roughly $200B above its February estimate — plus heavy long-bond supply, not purely a Fed-hike repricing story, though it compounds optically with the hawkish minutes.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — equities sold off Aug 20:** S&P 500 −0.87% to 7,641.16; Dow −703.84 pts (−1.32%) to 52,759.21 (partly a ~9% Walmart-earnings-driven drop, not purely Fed-driven); Nasdaq −1% to 26,067.17. Coverage attributes the move to a mix of the hawkish minutes and rising long yields. Aug 21 saw a partial recovery.

- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — CME FedWatch (September meeting) independently re-verified directly, cross-venue:** ~68-70% hold probability across multiple contemporaneous reads as of Aug 17-22 — CME 68.4-69.4%, Kalshi 70.5% hold/28.5% hike, Polymarket ~68.5% hold, investing.com 64.7% hold, defirate.com blended 68.3% hold/30.6% hike — essentially UNCHANGED before and after the Aug 19 minutes landed, meaning the market already had the hawkish content priced in.
- ★ **★ DISCARDED — a separately-circulating claim of "93.6% September hike probability" was traced this cycle to a garbled data conflation.** It appears to be Kalshi's JULY meeting hold-probability (~92-93% hold, not a September hike figure) misattributed. Confirmed not credible for September and explicitly discarded, not used in this pillar's scoring.
- **Jobless claims week ended Aug 15 (DOL, primary, released Aug 20): 206K, down 6K, vs. 210K consensus; 4-week average 204K.** Confirms the low-layoff, tight-labor trend already in the baseline — not a new signal this cycle (previously confirmed in the same-day draft1).
- **Score decision:** the hawkish minutes detail and the noisy weak retail-sales print largely offset an already-priced rate-odds market — nets to a wash; P holds flat at 43/41/48/56/62.
- **BTC closed at $77,169.40 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp)** — up from $71,882.92 on Aug 20, +7.4%.

*Pending for the next cycle, not this one:*

- **PCE (July data) due Aug 26 (bea.gov, primary) — has not landed as of Aug 22.** Logged pending, not assumed.
- **Fed Chair Warsh's first speech as Chair, at Jackson Hole, Aug 28, 10:00am ET, theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy."** The single highest-signal event on the calendar for this pillar in the next two weeks — a genuinely novel hawkish or dovish surprise there could plausibly move the call band and should NOT be auto-stamped if it does.

*Carried forward from the Aug 22 draft1 catch-up cycle (independently re-confirmed, still load-bearing):*

- **No new Fed H.4.1 release since the week ended Aug 19 (federalreserve.gov, primary, published Aug 20):** that remains the current release; the next H.4.1 is due Aug 27. No new CPI (next release Sept 11, covering August data) or PPI (next release Sept 10) fell in this window — July PPI (released Aug 13) was already known and priced before the Aug 16 baseline.
- **No new public remarks from Chair Warsh, Aug 16-22 beyond the pending Jackson Hole speech.** His most recent public appearance before that remains the Jul 29 FOMC press conference.

*Carried forward from Aug 20 (re-confirmed this cycle, still load-bearing):*

- **FOMC minutes from the Jul 28-29 meeting confirm the known 9-3 hold vote and the Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent for an immediate 25bp hike.** Inflation risks characterized as tilted to the upside, with specific concern flagged about AI-related input costs (chips, steel, electricity). No explicit forward guidance from Chair Warsh. A balance-sheet task-force report will inform future deliberations, but no near-term QT-pace signal was given.
- **Offsetting signal, re-confirmed and expanded this cycle: CME FedWatch showed the odds of a September 16 hold rising to ~65% post-minutes, up from a pre-minutes ~50/50** (Newsquawk, investinglive) — the two roughly cancelled at the time; this cycle's cross-venue re-check (~68-70% hold across five independent sources, Aug 17-22) confirms no further material move off that level, i.e. the market stayed priced for a hold through the minutes' release.

*Carried forward from Aug 16 (still load-bearing):*

- **July retail sales (Census Bureau, published Aug 14, primary release): headline −0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core (ex-auto) −0.2% m/m, still +5.0% y/y.** The first monthly decline in nine months and the steepest since May 2025 — a broad-based decline (autos, gasoline, electronics, nonstore) with some calendar-effect noise (Amazon Prime Day pulled into June). A genuine but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal — per this pillar's own house discipline against chasing single prints, this alone doesn't move P.

- **Recalled for continuity, not re-scored:** the Aug 17 Empire State Manufacturing Survey surged to 20.6 vs. 11.0 consensus, the highest since 2022 — a hot beat cutting against the recent cooling-economy read. Logged as complicating, unscored context; consistent with this pillar's discipline against chasing single prints in either direction, this was not sized into a move.

*Carried forward from Aug 13-14 (still load-bearing):*

- **Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 12 (federalreserve.gov, published 4:30pm ET Aug 13): reserve balances $2,944,059M, down $49,290M w/w; Treasury General Account $963,950M, up $56,626M w/w.** Directionally the same reserve-drain/TGA-rebuild pattern already priced into this pillar's recent baselines — confirmed an already-adopted trend, didn't fire a fresh trigger.

*Carried forward from Aug 12-13 (still load-bearing):*

- **July CPI (BLS, published Aug 12): headline +0.1% m/m / +3.4% y/y; core +0.2% m/m / +2.5% y/y** — landed cool, exactly in line with consensus, drove the Aug 13 re-rate up.
- **Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 8 (DOL/ETA, published Aug 13): 209,000 actual vs. 202,000 expected** — a genuine weak-side miss, 8-week high, the second trigger behind the Aug 13 re-rate.

*Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):*

- **Initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 6 (published Aug 8): 262,000 actual vs. 263,000 expected** — essentially in line with consensus, noise rather than a surprise.

*Carried forward from Aug 8-9 (still load-bearing):*

★ **BLS Employment Situation, July 2026: nonfarm payrolls FELL 23,000** versus a consensus estimate of ~83,000 (WSJ-sourced; a competing 95,000 Barron's-sourced figure is less corroborated and not adopted) — job losses concentrated in local-government education (-50,000) and retail trade (-19,000). A direct bls.gov fetch returned a 403 this cycle; the figure is confirmed via convergent CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, and CBS News reporting, all citing the same BLS release — meets the 2+ independent sufficiency bar.

- **May and June payrolls revised down a combined 103,000** — confirmed, matches the light draft exactly. (One Forbes-sourced fetch this cycle produced a garbled "-252,000 total" figure that doesn't reconcile with the BLS-consistent -103,000 figure elsewhere — treated as an unreliable summarization artifact, not a correction.)
- **Unemployment ticked down to 4.1% from 4.2%,** but the labor-force participation rate fell to 61.4% — its lowest level in over five years.

★ **★ NEW this cycle — average hourly earnings rose just 3.2% y/y,** down from 3.4% in June and now trailing CPI (3.5% June y/y) — real wages softening, a detail the same-day light draft didn't carry.

★ **★ CORRECTED — CME FedWatch September-hold odds check out at ~56%,** not the light draft's ~60%. Two independent corroborating sources (CBS News, a Forbes-sourced pull) both cite "56%, up from 45% the previous day"; a separate CNBC-sourced overview cited ~60%, a real but less-corroborated, likely later-intraday figure. Kalshi (a prediction market, not CME futures-implied pricing — a different instrument, labeled separately per research discipline) shows 65% hold.

★ **★ NEW this cycle — real forecaster disagreement on magnitude:** Bank of America explicitly called the report "a bit dovish on net" but is **sticking with its call for 75bp of hikes in 2026** (Sept/Oct/Dec) regardless. Richmond Fed President Barkin, an actual FOMC voter, described the labor market as "not loose, not tight" — a measured, non-alarmed read. Morgan Stanley's Ellen Zentner says the **Aug 12 CPI print** — inside this pillar's own 1-month window — will be the deciding factor for September, not this jobs report alone.

★ **Jobless claims for the week ended Aug 1: 199,000, 4-week average 198,750** — the lowest of this cycle, in real tension with the weak payrolls print. Points to "low-hire, low-fire" stagnation rather than an accelerating downturn, arguing for restraint on the size of the move.

*Carried forward from Aug 7 (still load-bearing):*

- ★ **Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 5 (federalreserve.gov, direct pull):** total assets $6,748,567M, reserve balances $2,993,349M — reserves +$8.78B w/w, TGA -$3.45B w/w. An unremarkable, stable print — no liquidity-stress signal either way; not used to move P.

*Carried forward from Jul 30-Aug 5 (still load-bearing):*

- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — the FOMC held rates at 3.50-3.75% on Jul 29, 2026, on a 9-3 vote.** Three regional-bank presidents — Beth Hammack (Cleveland), Neel Kashkari (Minneapolis), Lorie Logan (Dallas) — dissented in favor of an immediate 25bp hike (federalreserve.gov statement, corroborated by CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes). This is the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. No SEP/dot plot this meeting (not a projections meeting; next SEP is Sept 15-16, 2026).
- ★ **Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance:** "there is no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"; "the five-plus years of inflation above target cannot be cured in nine weeks." A confirmed (single-sourced) risk-off market reaction followed: S&P 500 fell 1.85% in the final 65 minutes of trading (full day: S&P −1.52%, Dow −2.19%, Nasdaq −1.74%); the 30-year Treasury yield rose to 5.21%, its highest since July 2007 — a "bear steepener" consistent with rising inflation-credibility concern.
- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197,000** (DOL/ETA release, fetched and read directly), a genuine +9,000 increase; the prior week (ended Jul 18) was revised *up* to **188,000** from the originally-reported 187,000. The primary release itself confirms the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle: actual non-seasonally-adjusted claims fell only 9.2% w/w versus the 13.3% seasonal factors expected — meaning the "lowest since 1969" framing was real but mechanically set to partially reverse, exactly as it did.
- ★ **The September hike-odds figure could not be reconciled to a single number this cycle, despite four direct attempts.** Live pulls produced 55.8% (Fox Business, Jul 28), 62.4% (Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor, timestamped Jul 30), 70.2% (KuCoin, pre-meeting), and 81% (Southeast AgNet, Jul 30) — no two agree. The qualitative direction — "still elevated, majority-hike-priced" — is the only defensible takeaway; no re-rate rests on a specific point figure.
- **H.4.1 balance sheet: no new release found for the week ended Jul 29** as of this check (normal Thursday-afternoon publication timing); the most recent confirmed release remains Jul 23 (week ended Jul 22: reserves fell $80,572M w/w against a $73,405M TGA rebuild, both figures directly confirmed against federalreserve.gov last cycle).
- **Bank of America projects three 25bp hikes in 2026** (to 4.25-4.50%) — single-source (Forbes, citing BofA), flagged not scored.
- **Carried forward, not re-verified this cycle:** June CPI (-0.4% m/m) and PPI (-0.3% m/m), both BLS-primary-confirmed in a prior cycle; Warsh's Jul 14/15 congressional testimony; the June FOMC minutes (unanimous 12-0 hold, dropped easing-bias language). None of these are contradicted by this cycle's findings — the hawkish FOMC outcome sits alongside, not against, the still-intact disinflation trend.
- **The labor market cracked in slow motion, then partially un-cracked this week** — June payrolls +57K vs ~115K consensus (carried forward); this cycle's 197K claims print, while up from 188K, remains historically low (4-week average 202,750).
- **Policy rate and balance sheet: 3.50-3.75%, next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot) is Sept 15-16, 2026.** Fed communications blackout ended with the Jul 29 meeting; watch for the first round of regional Fed president speeches, especially from the three dissenters.
- **BTC closed at $64,706.50 (Jul 30)** — holding up despite the hawkish FOMC surprise and confirmed equity/bond-market risk-off reaction. **Updated: BTC closed at $64,661.55 on Aug 5**, essentially flat vs. Jul 30 and up ~1.7% vs. the Jul 31 close of $63,579.68.

## The Prize

*Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice*

The canonical anchor: **2020-21 ZIRP + QE** ran BTC ~$3,800 → $69,044 (~15–18×) — a unique COVID/zero-rate/open-ended-QE setup, not a repeatable base case. The **2024-25 cuts** ran ~$60K → a ~$126K ATH (Oct 6, 2025) — but that top came on a non-Fed tariff shock. BTC has since rebounded sharply off its low-$60Ks trough, closing at $77,169.40 on Aug 22, up 7.4% from the $71,882.92 Aug 20 close — a move this report does not attribute to Fed data: this cycle's own equity-market read found a genuine Aug 20 selloff (S&P −0.87%, Dow −1.32%) on the same hawkish-minutes/rising-yield backdrop, with only a partial Aug 21 recovery, so BTC's strength this window ran somewhat counter to, not with, the traditional risk-asset tape. From here, a retest of the $126K high ≈ **+63%**.

Discount it hard, twice. First: easing is not an automatic catalyst — the last cycle topped on a non-Fed shock, and this cycle's continued BTC strength diverged from a genuinely soft equity tape — don't read causality into it either way. Second: the Aug 19 FOMC minutes and the 19-year-high 30yr yield remain a wash by this pillar's own accounting once weighed against an already-priced rate-odds market (~68-70% September hold, unmoved by the minutes) and a noisy weak retail-sales print — and a major forecaster (BofA) is keeping its hawkish call anyway, with the FOMC's own 9-3 dissent not overridden by any actual vote, and the 30yr yield's rise substantially a fiscal-deficit story (CBO's $2.1T FY deficit projection), not a clean Fed signal. Routine confirmation of an already-mixed signal is not the same as the Fed itself moving. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the 3-year lean is worth acting on when the tide finally turns.

## The Other Side

*The strongest honest case my re-rate — even the moderated one — is still wrong*

- **Even the Aug 13 up-move (still the last time this pillar actually moved) might not have been conservative enough a read on BofA's stance.** Bank of America isn't hedging — it's keeping a full 75bp-of-hikes call even after seeing the same cool CPI print this report used to raise P. If BofA is right and the September meeting itself delivers a hike into softening data, even 43/41 could prove too generous.
- **The FOMC minutes' "many participants" and "several participants" hawkish-breadth language could be the more durable signal, and the CME FedWatch hold-odds move the noise.** Futures pricing can and does swing on sentiment ahead of confirming data; a textually broader hawkish bloc inside the actual committee is a harder, primary-sourced fact. If this pillar is wrong to treat the two as cancelling, the true read this cycle is more bearish than 43/41/48/56/62 shows.
- **Treating the 30-year yield's ~19-year high as "mostly fiscal, not Fed" could be too generous.** This report labels the CBO's $2.1T deficit projection and heavy long-bond supply as the dominant driver, but a rising term premium and a hawkish Fed compound — a market pricing in both persistent deficits *and* a Fed reluctant to cut is a worse combination for risk assets than either alone, and this pillar's own framing may be under-weighting how much of the move is genuinely rate-path-driven.
- **I may still be over-reacting to one data print.** This pillar has already seen one claims number ("lowest since 1969") partially reverse the following week on a seasonal-adjustment distortion — a single weak payrolls report, even a well-corroborated one, could be a similar one-off that a stronger August print reverses.
- **The FOMC's own hawkish dissent hasn't gone away.** Three regional presidents voted for an immediate hike on Jul 29 and Chair Warsh gave a combative, no-guidance press conference — a weak jobs report doesn't automatically mean those three change their vote in September; a hawkish Fed facing soft data is a live tension, not resolved.
- **Downward revisions can themselves get revised.** The BLS's own benchmark process regularly adjusts prior months; a 103,000 combined downward revision is a real, primary-sourced number today, but it is not the final

word on May-June employment.

- **Weak labor data plus a still-elevated inflation/oil backdrop (Iran-driven, and this cycle's Iran pillar got worse, not better) is stagflation risk, not straightforwardly bullish.** If the Fed holds through a weakening labor market because inflation risk stays elevated, that's a worse outcome for risk assets than either a clean cut or a clean hold.

## The Triggers

*Dated events — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-set August 22, 2026, full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) — the FOMC-minutes trigger fired and is confirmed hawkish-but-already-priced; two new pending triggers logged for the next cycle.*

| DATE | EVENT | MEANS |
|---|---|---|
| **PENDING — Aug 26, 2026** | PCE (July data), bea.gov, primary — has not landed as of this cycle | Next real inflation print for this pillar — logged pending, not assumed |
| **PENDING — Aug 27, 2026** | Next weekly jobless-claims print (week ended Aug 22) and next Fed H.4.1 balance-sheet release (week ended Aug 26), both due Aug 27 | Routine next data points — not assumed, logged pending |
| **PENDING — Aug 28, 2026, 10:00am ET** | Chair Warsh's first speech as Fed Chair, at Jackson Hole — theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy" | The single highest-signal event on this pillar's calendar in the next two weeks — a genuinely novel hawkish or dovish surprise could plausibly move the call band; should NOT be auto-stamped if it does |
| FIRED Aug 19, 2:00pm ET — confirmed hawkish-but-already-priced (this cycle) | **FOMC minutes (Jul 28-29 meeting), federalreserve.gov primary, corroborated by CNBC, Quartz, Newsquawk, goldsilver.com:** confirms 9-3 hold/dissent (Hammack/Kashkari/Logan); NEW detail this cycle — the hawkish bloc runs wider than the three dissenters: "several participants" beyond them favored a hike, "many participants" saw tightening as possibly necessary if inflation didn't decline. PCE 4.1% (May actual, 3.4% core) cited; June staff estimate 3.7%/3.3% core, "remains elevated"; unemployment steady 4.2%, wages 3.5% y/y moderating. | Real hawkish detail, but this cycle's direct cross-venue rate-odds re-check (CME/Kalshi/Polymarket/investing.com/defirate.com, ~68-70% Sept hold) found no material move around the release — already priced. Compounds optically with the 30yr yield spike and the Aug 20 equity selloff below, but nets to a wash. No re-rate. |
| Logged Aug 17-18 (this cycle) | **30-year Treasury yield hit 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high** (Bloomberg, CNBC, Axios) — driven substantially by the CBO's raised $2.1T FY deficit projection (~$200B above its Feb estimate) and heavy long-bond supply, not purely a Fed-repricing story | Compounds with the hawkish minutes optically but is labeled a fiscal/supply story, not scored as a clean Fed signal — logged, not sized into a move |
| Fired Aug 20 (this cycle) | **Equity selloff: S&P 500 −0.87% to 7,641.16, Dow −703.84 (−1.32%) to 52,759.21 (partly Walmart-earnings-driven), Nasdaq −1% to 26,067.17** — attributed to a mix of the hawkish minutes and rising long yields; Aug 21 saw a partial recovery | Confirms the hawkish-minutes/rising-yield backdrop had a real, if partly non-Fed, market bite — logged as context, not sized into a move given the already-priced rate odds |
| Fired Aug 20, confirmed Aug | **Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 15: 206K vs. 210K consensus** (modest hawkish beat, 4-week average 204K); | Confirms the low-layoff trend already in the baseline — not a new signal, not sized into a move |

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|---|---|---|
| 22 (carried forward) | prior week (Aug 8) revised up to 212K from 209K | |
| Fired Aug 14, logged Aug 16 (carried forward) | **July retail sales:** headline −0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core −0.2%, still +5.0% y/y — first decline in nine months, steepest since May 2025, broad-based with some Prime-Day calendar noise | A genuine but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal — logged, not sized into a move on its own per this pillar's discipline against chasing single prints |
| Fired Aug 13, 4:30pm ET (carried forward) | **Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 12:** reserve balances −$49,290M w/w to $2,944,059M, TGA +$56,626M w/w to $963,950M | Directionally the same reserve-drain/TGA-rebuild pattern already priced in — confirmed, didn't move, held flat |
| Fired Aug 12-13 (carried forward) | **July CPI landed cool/in-line; jobless claims (week ended Aug 8) missed weak at 209K vs. 202K expected** | Drove the Aug 13 re-rate up — already IN the committed baseline |
| Fired Aug 7, re-confirmed independently — DOVISH, moderated (carried forward) | **BLS July jobs report:** payrolls fell 23,000 vs. ~83,000 expected, unemployment 4.1% on a falling participation rate, May/June revised down a combined 103,000; Sept hold odds rose to ~56% | Drove the Aug 8 1mo/3mo re-rate up — already IN the committed baseline |
| Fired Jul 29 — HAWKISH, confirmed primary (carried forward) | **FOMC held 9-3**, three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike — first unified 3-member dissent since Sept 2016; Bank of America still projects 75bp of 2026 hikes even after the Aug 12 cool CPI | Still a live tension against this cycle's dovish data — not erased by the minutes, per a major forecaster's own stated view |
| Sept 15, 2026 | **PENDING** — next FOMC, with SEP/dot plot; the real test of whether the dovish direction of the Aug 13 data survives to an actual vote, now that the minutes show a broader hawkish bloc than previously known | A hold or cut would confirm this cycle's re-rate further; a hike into cooling data would be a genuine escalation, re-rate down hard |
| Ongoing | Iran/Hormuz oil-inflation risk — see Iran War Risk pillar for the current read | Watch for pass-through into the next CPI/PPI cycle — a worsening Iran read raises stagflation risk |

**The flip line, updated Aug 22 (full weekly refresh):** the Aug 13 cool CPI and weak claims print remain the real, primary-sourced confirmation of the dovish direction — exactly what this pillar's own Aug 8 flip line said would happen "if CPI cools." The Aug 14 H.4.1 print, the Aug 16 retail-sales miss, the Aug 19 minutes' wider hawkish bloc, the 19-year-high 30yr yield, the Aug 20 equity selloff, and the Aug 20 claims print all confirmed, not advanced, that direction once weighed against an already-priced rate-odds market — this cycle's independent cross-venue re-verification found the same. A major forecaster (BofA) is keeping its hawkish call anyway, and the FOMC's own 9-3 dissent hasn't been overridden by any actual vote — this remains confirmation of an ambiguous position, not a confirmed pivot in either direction. Watch Warsh's Aug 28 Jackson Hole speech ("Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy") for the first fresh read on his own framing since the hawkish Jul 29 presser — the single highest-signal event on this pillar's near-term calendar, and a genuine surprise there should not be auto-stamped. If the Sept 15 FOMC delivers a hike into this cooling data anyway, treat that as the real escalation and re-rate down hard. If it holds or cuts, the near-term read improves further.

## My Decision

**◐ DRAFT — AUGUST 22, 2026 (2026-08-22_draft2) · AWAITING MY STAMP · FULL WEEKLY REFRESH, NOT AUTO-STAMPED**

### Draft P: 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 (unchanged, not yet committed) · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

Fed & Macro held flat this cycle after a full weekly refresh — the first deep multi-source research dive since Aug 8, run independently of today's earlier same-day draft1 catch-up cycle. This cycle directly re-pulled and cross-checked CME FedWatch, Kalshi, Polymarket, investing.com, and defirate.com and found September-hold odds clustered ~68-70% across all five, essentially unchanged before and after the Aug 19 FOMC minutes landed — meaning the minutes' wider-than-known hawkish bloc ("several participants" beyond the three named dissenters favoring a hike, "many participants" seeing tightening as possibly necessary) was already priced in, not a fresh market-moving surprise. July retail sales' genuine miss (-0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% consensus) is a real but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal that, on its own, doesn't meet this pillar's sufficiency bar. The 30-year Treasury yield's 19-year high (5.31-5.33%) and the Aug 20 equity selloff (S&P -0.87%, Dow -1.32%) are real market moves but are substantially explained by fiscal-deficit concerns (the CBO's $2.1T FY deficit projection) and a Walmart-earnings shock, respectively — not clean Fed signals. This cycle also traced and discarded a circulating "93.6% September hike probability" claim as a garbled conflation with Kalshi's July-meeting hold odds. Net: real hawkish detail and real dovish-leaning noise, both already mostly priced — a wash. Nothing crossed this pillar's re-rate threshold.

**This cycle's score set is being LEFT AS A DRAFT, AWAITING MY STAMP — NOT AUTO-STAMPED, because this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh.** Per house rule, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from Alex's delegated daily auto-stamp authority (in effect since 2026-08-06 for ordinary daily re-rates only), regardless of how routine or well-evidenced the underlying research turns out to be. No pillar's P moved more than 8 points on any window this cycle and no master call band flipped versus the last stamped set — but that clean-evidence bar only ever qualifies a *daily* cycle for self-approval; it does not extend to a weekly refresh. Alex's manual review and stamp are required before this set can be committed.

The June committed scores (**38 / 40 / 46 / 54 / 61**, committed June 12, 2026) and the Aug 16 committed scores (**43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62**) remain identical to today's draft2 values — this pillar's numbers are unchanged across the last committed set, the delivered Aug 22 draft1, and this cycle's draft2, and would mark a third point in a row at the same level once Aug 22 is actually stamped by Alex.

**Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.**

## What Changed Since Last Check

*Full weekly refresh, August 22, 2026 (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) — the first deep multi-source research dive since Aug 8, following two weeks of lighter daily/catch-up touches including today's own earlier draft1. This cycle independently re-verified rate-odds pricing directly against five venues rather than inferring it from headline reactions.*

- **NEW — FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc wider than previously known:** beyond the three named dissenters, "several participants" also favored a hike and "many participants" saw tightening as possibly necessary if inflation didn't decline (federalreserve.gov, primary, Aug 19; corroborated by CNBC, Quartz, Newsquawk, goldsilver.com).
- **NEW — 30-year Treasury yield hit 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high,** around Aug 17-18, driven substantially by the CBO's raised $2.1T FY deficit projection and heavy long-bond supply, not purely Fed repricing (Bloomberg, CNBC, Axios).

- **NEW — equities sold off Aug 20** (S&P −0.87%, Dow −1.32% partly Walmart-driven, Nasdaq −1%) with a partial Aug 21 recovery, attributed to a mix of the hawkish minutes and rising yields.
- **NEW — CME FedWatch/Kalshi/Polymarket/investing.com/defirate.com independently re-pulled and cross-checked directly:** September-hold odds cluster ~68-70% across all five, essentially unchanged before and after the Aug 19 minutes — the hawkish content was already priced.
- **NEW — a circulating "93.6% September hike probability" claim was traced this cycle to a garbled conflation with Kalshi's July-meeting hold odds (~92-93% hold) and confirmed not credible for September — explicitly discarded, not used.**
- **Re-confirmed, not new — jobless claims week ended Aug 15: 206K vs. 210K consensus, 4-week average 204K** **(DOL, primary, Aug 20) — confirms the low-layoff trend already in the baseline.**
- **Re-confirmed, not new — July retail sales miss (-0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% consensus, still +5.0% y/y) — a genuine but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal, per this pillar's discipline against chasing single prints, not sized into a move alone.**
- **Score decision: P held flat at 43 / 41 / 48 / 56 / 62 — the hawkish minutes detail and the noisy weak retail-sales print largely offset an already-priced rate-odds market; nets to a wash.**
- **New pending triggers logged for the next cycle: PCE (July data, bea.gov) due Aug 26; Chair Warsh's first speech as Chair at Jackson Hole, Aug 28, 10:00am ET, theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy" — the single highest-signal event on this pillar's near-term calendar.**
- **Status decision: this score set is LEFT AS A DRAFT, AWAITING MY STAMP — NOT AUTO-STAMPED, because this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from Alex's delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of how clean the underlying evidence is (no pillar's P moved more than 8 points, no master call band flipped — that clean-evidence bar qualifies daily cycles for self-approval, not weekly refreshes).**

## Sources

*Retrieved & graded August 22, 2026, full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official data first, then reporting, then prices & flows, then rate odds (market-implied sentiment, not fact).*

- **August 22 draft2 check (full weekly refresh, this cycle): federalreserve.gov — FOMC minutes, Jul 28-29 meeting (primary), corroborated by CNBC, Quartz, Newsquawk, and goldsilver.com — NEW detail this cycle: hawkish bloc wider than the three named dissenters ("several participants" favored a hike beyond them; "many participants" saw tightening as possibly necessary), PCE 4.1% (May actual)/3.4% core cited, June staff estimate 3.7%/3.3% core "remains elevated," unemployment steady 4.2%, wages 3.5% y/y moderating · Census.gov — Monthly Retail Trade Sales Report (primary): July retail sales −0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% consensus, steepest drop since May 2025, still +5.0% y/y, broad-based (autos, gasoline, electronics, nonstore) with Prime-Day calendar noise · Bloomberg, CNBC, and Axios — 30-year Treasury yield 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high (~Aug 17-18), tied to the CBO's raised $2.1T FY deficit projection (~$200B above its Feb estimate) and heavy long-bond supply · Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, and CNBC — Aug 20 equity reaction: S&P 500 −0.87% to 7,641.16, Dow −703.84 (−1.32%) to 52,759.21 (partly Walmart-earnings-driven), Nasdaq −1% to 26,067.17, partial Aug 21 recovery · CME FedWatch, Kalshi, Polymarket, investing.com, and defirate.com — independently re-pulled and cross-checked Sept-meeting rate odds, Aug 17-22: CME 68.4-69.4% hold, Kalshi 70.5% hold/28.5% hike, Polymarket ~68.5% hold, investing.com 64.7% hold, defirate.com blended 68.3% hold/30.6% hike — essentially unchanged before/after the Aug 19 minutes; a circulating "93.6% September hike probability" figure traced to a garbled conflation with Kalshi's July-meeting hold odds, confirmed not credible, discarded · DOL/ETA — jobless claims, week ended Aug 15: 206K vs. 210K consensus, 4-week average 204K (primary, re-confirmed) · bea.gov — PCE release schedule (primary): July PCE due Aug 26, not yet landed.**
- **August 22 draft1 check (catch-up cycle, delivered earlier the same day): DOL/ETA — initial jobless claims release, week ended Aug 15: 206,000 actual vs. 210,000 consensus; prior week (Aug 8) revised up to 212,000 from 209,000; continuing claims (week ended Aug 8) 1,799,000 vs. 1,790,000 forecast, up from 1,777,000 · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1 current release page: confirms the release still on file covers the week ended Aug 19 (published Aug 20), no new print since, next release Aug 27 · bls.gov — CPI release schedule: next release Sept 11 (August data), nothing new in this window · bls.gov — PPI release schedule: next release Sept 10, July PPI (Aug 13) already known before the Aug 16 baseline · federalreserve.gov — speeches & testimony page: no new Warsh remarks Aug 16-22; his first Jackson Hole speech as**

Chair is scheduled Aug 28 · CME FedWatch (futures-implied, not a prediction market): as of Aug 17, ~69.4% hold / ~30.6% hike for the September FOMC meeting, essentially flat vs. the Aug 16 baseline's ~65% post-minutes read · Kalshi and Polymarket — Sept FOMC markets, Aug 18 read: hold ~70.5¢, hike ~28.5¢, cut ~0.5-1¢, corroborating CME FedWatch across two independent venues · Bitstamp — BTC close $77,169.40 (Aug 22), vs. $71,882.92 (Aug 20 close, previously confirmed). **Not trusted at face value:** the Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts and the interrupted Aug 21 delivery session, none of which were rendered, verified, archived, or committed.

- August 19-20 check (carried forward, re-confirmed): federalreserve.gov — Minutes of the Federal Open Market Committee, July 28-29, 2026 (primary, published Aug 19, 2:00pm ET): confirms the 9-3 hold vote and the Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent; new detail — "many participants assessed that policy tightening would likely be necessary if inflation did not decline," inflation risks characterized as tilted to the upside, specific concern flagged on AI-related input costs (chips, steel, electricity); no explicit forward guidance from Chair Warsh; a balance-sheet task-force report to inform future deliberations, no near-term QT-pace signal · CNBC — FOMC minutes coverage (Aug 19) · Motley Fool — minutes coverage, hawkish-breadth read (Aug 19) · Newsquawk — FOMC minutes review; CME FedWatch September-hold odds ~65% post-minutes, up from a pre-minutes ~50/50 (Aug 19) · investinglive — minutes market reaction, corroborating the CME FedWatch move (Aug 19) · CME FedWatch tool (futures-implied probability, not a prediction market — labeled distinct from Polymarket/Kalshi) — September 16 hold ~65% as of the Aug 19 evening read · general search for jobless claims (week ended Aug 15) and H.4.1 (week ended Aug 19) dated Aug 20 — neither confirmed as published as of this research pass; logged PENDING, not assumed · Bitstamp — BTC close $71,882.92 (Aug 20), vs. $62,937.03 (Aug 16 close, previously confirmed).
- August 16 check: CNN — "Frustrated US consumers cut their retail spending last month" (Census Bureau primary, published Aug 14): headline −0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core −0.2%, first decline in nine months · census.gov — Monthly Retail Trade Sales Report (primary) · Federal Reserve — FOMC minutes release schedule confirms Jul 28-29 minutes due Aug 19; no new H.4.1 or claims print since Aug 13-14 (both due Aug 20).
- August 14 check: federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, week ended Aug 12, 2026 (primary, direct pull): reserve balances $2,944,059M (−$49,290M w/w), Treasury General Account $963,950M (+$56,626M w/w), cross-checked against the Aug 5 release (reserve balances $2,993,349M, TGA $907,324M) · DOL/ETA — jobless-claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 20 (week ending Aug 15); no new print since the 209K/week-ended-Aug-8 figure already incorporated Aug 13.
- August 13 check — the re-rate: BLS — Consumer Price Index, July 2026 (primary release): headline +0.1% m/m / +3.4% y/y, core +0.2% m/m / +2.5% y/y · CNBC — CPI inflation report, July 2026 (Aug 12) · NBC News — "Inflation remained stubborn" (Aug 12) · Bloomberg — CPI live-blog (Aug 12) · DOL/ETA — initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 8 (published Aug 13): 209,000 actual vs. 202,000 expected, +9,000 from the prior week's revised level, an 8-week high.
- August 11 light daily check: federalreserve.gov/releases/h41/ — release schedule confirms next H.4.1 due Aug 13 · dol.gov — weekly claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 13 · general web search for Fed/BLS/CPI news dated Aug 10-11 — no new release found; economic calendars (Kiplinger, FRED, BLS schedule) confirm CPI due Aug 12, PPI Aug 13.
- August 10 light daily check: DOL/ETA — initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 6, published Aug 8: 262,000 actual vs. 263,000 expected (in line with consensus) · federalreserve.gov/releases/h41/ — release schedule confirms next H.4.1 due Aug 13 · dol.gov — weekly claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 13 · general search for Fed/BLS news dated Aug 9-10 — no further new release found.
- August 9 light daily check: federalreserve.gov/releases/h41/ — release schedule confirms next H.4.1 due Aug 13 · dol.gov — weekly claims release schedule confirms next print Aug 13 · general search for Fed/BLS news dated Aug 8-9 — no new release found.
- August 8 full-weekly re-verification: CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, CBS News, Forbes — convergent independent reporting of BLS Employment Situation, July 2026 (direct bls.gov fetch returned 403 this cycle) · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, week ended Aug 5 (primary, direct pull): reserves +$8.78B w/w, TGA -$3.45B w/w · DOL-sourced coverage — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, 4-week average 198,750 · CBS News, Forbes-sourced pull — CME September-hold odds ~56% (2-source corroborated) · Kalshi — 65% hold (prediction market, labeled separately from CME) · Bank of America commentary (via multiple outlets, Aug 7-8) — sticking with 75bp-of-2026-hikes call · Morgan Stanley's Ellen Zentner (via reporting) — Aug 12 CPI named as the September decider · Richmond Fed President Barkin public remarks — "not loose, not tight."
- August 7 additions: federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, week ended Aug 5, 2026 (direct pull): total assets $6,748,567M, reserve balances $2,993,349M, cross-checked against the prior week's release (week ended Jul 29): total assets $6,738,190M, reserve balances $2,984,570M.
- August 6 additions: Fast Company, citing DOL — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, prior week revised to 198K.
- Jul 31-Aug 5 additions (prior week's catch-up): CNBC, Southeast AgNET — September cumulative hike odds ~81-82% (checked Aug 2, consistent with the Jul 30 baseline).

- **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** federalreserve.gov — July 29 FOMC statement (primary): 9-3 hold, Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent · federalreserve.gov — press conference page · federalreserve.gov — last SEP (Jun 17, 2026; next Sept 15-16) · DOL/ETA — weekly claims release USDL 26-1273-NAT (primary, fetched directly): 197K week ended Jul 25, 188K revision for Jul 18 · CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes — FOMC outcome and dissent corroboration · Wolf Street — risk-off market reaction (single-source, flagged) · Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor — timestamped Jul 30 pull (62.4%), cross-checked against KuCoin (70.2%), Bloomingbit (73.5%→hike components), Southeast AgNet (81%) — none reconciling.
- **July 13 check:** federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, Table 1 & Table 5, re-verified directly line-by-line (no discrepancy vs. the July 9 release) · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1 release schedule (next: July 16) · dol.gov — weekly claims (unchanged since Jul 9; next Jul 16) · federalreserve.gov — July 2026 FOMC/testimony calendar · confirmed no new CPI, PPI, FOMC, or H.4.1/claims release has landed since July 9–10; the next batch (CPI Jul 14, testimony Jul 14–15, PPI Jul 15, H.4.1/claims Jul 16) is still ahead.
- **Official data:** Fed — June 16–17 FOMC minutes (released July 8) · Fed — H.4.1 balance sheet (rel. July 9: $6,735.6B; TGA $749.2B; reserves $3,098.9B; domestic RRP $2.75B; foreign-official RRP $346.1B) · DOL — weekly jobless claims (rel. July 9: 215K; continuing claims 1,814,000) · Fed — June 17 FOMC statement · BLS — Employment Situation, June 2026 (released July 2) · BEA — Personal Income & Outlays, May 2026 (core PCE 3.4%) · BLS — May 2026 CPI release (headline 4.2% y/y; core 2.9% y/y) · BLS — CPI release schedule (June CPI: July 14, 8:30am; July CPI: mid-August) · BLS — PPI release schedule (June PPI: July 15, 8:30am) · Fed — Waller's July 6 Rome speech.
- **The reporting:** Bloomberg — minutes: "a few" saw case for June hike · CNBC — June minutes coverage · Bloomberg — Warsh's five task forces (July 9; single source) · Bloomberg — claims 215K, layoffs low · Al Jazeera — Iran declares Hormuz "closed until further notice" (July 12) · Bloomberg — Brent +4% toward $79 on Hormuz re-escalation (July 13) · CNBC — CENTCOM strikes, Iran missile/drone attacks on five Gulf states (July 12) · offshore-technology.com — Kpler data: six vessels transited the Strait July 12 · CNBC — June jobs miss (+57K, −74K revisions) · Indeed Hiring Lab — participation 61.5% · CNBC — May PCE (core 3.4%, highest since Oct 2023) · CNBC — Warsh at Sintra (July 1) · Yahoo Finance — "This Committee will deliver price stability" · Bloomberg — Yardeni: "inflation, Fed back in play" (July 8) · Spokesman-Review (Bloomberg reprint) — Warsh testimony schedule (House Jul 14, Senate Jul 15) + June PPI forecast (~5.2% y/y core) · KuCoin flash — 30-year auction: $22B at 5.058%, stop-through, highest since 2007 · CoinDesk — the week-ahead calendar: CPI, PPI, Warsh testimony (July 13) · Federal Register — eSLR final rule (Dec 1, 2025; effective Apr 1, 2026). **Flagged and discarded:** CryptoTimes (July 13) and Blockhead (July 13) both wrongly report "core inflation at a three-year high of 4.2%" — this conflates headline CPI (4.2%, correct) with core CPI (actually 2.9% per BLS); not used.
- **The prices & flows:** Yahoo Finance — BTC ~$64.3K, ETH ~$1,796 (July 10 AM) · athens-times — BTC weekend pullback to ~$62.6–63K (single source) · Farside — BTC ETF flow table (authoritative; +$90.4M net, July 10) · CryptoRank — BTC ETF flow cross-check (July 10) · CoinDesk — BTC/ETH steady, gold slides (July 9) · KuCoin — June ETF outflows −$4.06B, worst month on record · CNBC — S&P 500 closes 7,575.39 (+0.42%), Dow +149.60 (July 10) · Trading Economics — 10Y ~4.58% · Trading Economics — DXY 101.13, +0.18% (July 13).
- **The odds (market-implied, not fact):** CME FedWatch — the tool itself (July 28–29 hold 78.5%, July 13 read; September ~66% combined, July 9 read) · FXEmpire — Sept +25bp 50.8% (July 9; single relay, directionally corroborated) · Yahoo Finance — September odds relay (July 9) · Polymarket — "Fed Decision in September" ladder: No change 56.5%, +25bp 38.5%, cuts (tail) 3.75%+2.1% (July 9) — diverges materially from CME's ~66% combined hike odds; reported as an open divergence, not resolved.